

Dermochelys coriacea

Leatherback sea turtle

Family (Dermochelyidae)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered)

Description

The leatherback is the largest, deepest diving, and most migratory and wide ranging of all sea turtles. The adult leatherback can reach 4 to 8 feet in length and 500 to 2000 pounds in weight. Its shell is composed of a mosaic of small bones covered by firm, rubbery skin with seven longitudinal ridges or keels.



Location/Habitat



The species historical range included Alabama, Alaska, American Samoa, California, Connecticut, Delaware, Florida, Georgia, Guam, Hawaii, Louisiana, Maine, Maryland, Massachusetts, Mississippi, New Hampshire, New Jersey, New York, North Carolina, Northern Mariana Islands, Oregon, Puerto Rico, Rhode Island, South Carolina, Texas, Virginia, Virgin Islands, Washington.